



Stephanie McGovern, 4, of Middleville gets a helpful push from mom Laurie Rhyndress at the Gem-mill Park toboggan hill Friday afternoon. After a slow start to the season, many families have taken advantage of the warmer weather to enjoy this winter fun.

Local 46th Christmas Bird Count sees increase in species spotted

The 46th annual Carleton Place Bird Count which took place Friday, Dec. 27, found two species never before recorded on the count.

The local edition was one of about 1,700 counts taking place over the Christmas period as part of the 97th annual Audubon Christmas Bird Count, which is designed to help survey the wintering birds of Canada, U.S.A., Central America and the Caribbean. In this area, the count is sponsored by the Mississippi Valley Field Naturalists.

Twenty-three field observers took part here, counting birds from cars and on foot from 8 a.m. until 4:30 p.m. in a 25 kilometre (15 mile) diameter circle centred on the bridge in Carleton Place and also taking in Almonte, Appleton and Ashton. As well, 34 feeder watchers counted birds at their backyard feeders. The day started cold (-12c) and a bit foggy but warmed up to -4c in sunshine and with no wind. It was a perfect day for birding.

The number of species recorded this year was up to 37 from 35 last year, which is still a little lower than normal. The total number of birds seen was the lowest since 1988 at 4,481.

Local field naturalists hear results of monitoring program

Many area residents volunteered in a seven-year program helping to monitor the nesting sites of red-shouldered hawks and goshawks in Lanark County. Now's the chance to hear the results and recommendations of that fascinating survey.

Brian Naylor, program

coordinator and habitat specialist from North Bay, will be on hand to give everyone the details. Members of the Rideau Valley Naturalists Group will join in this evening, as they also took part in the monitoring.

This is a great chance to meet some neighbouring nature lovers and learn a lot about some interesting raptor work. The group will meet at the Mill of Kintail Gatehouse at 7:30 p.m. on Jan. 16. For information please call 257-8206 or 257-2164. Membership in the MVFN is not required to attend.

follows:

Common Loon, 1
Common Goldeneye, 7
Hooded Merganser, 1
Common Merganser, 8
Northern Harrier, 1
Cooper's Hawk, 1
Red-tailed Hawk, 2
Rough-legged Hawk, 2
Ruffed Grouse, 3
Rock Dove, 371
Mourning Dove, 144
Downy Woodpecker, 49
Hairy Woodpecker, 63
Northern Flicker, 1
Pileated Woodpecker, 10
Blue Jay, 471
American Crow, 519
Common Raven, 2
Black-capped Chickadee, 609
Red-breasted Nuthatch, 4
White-breasted Nuthatch, 75
American Robin, 2
Cedar Waxwing, 161

Northern Shrike, 3
European Starling, 544
Northern Cardinal, 18
Rose-breasted Grosbeak, 1
American Tree Sparrow, 117
Song Sparrow, 1
Dark-eyed Junco, 40
Snow Bunting, 95
Purple Finch, 73
House Finch, 73
Common Redpoll, 1
American Goldfinch, 680
Evening Grosbeak, 75
House Sparrow, 254.

At the end of the day, many of the participants gathered at the Ramsay Township office to see the results come in and have a snack. The count was organized by Arnie Simpson and the results were compiled by Mike Jaques. The feeder counts were organized by Georgina Doe.

Demand grows for organic crops

Farmers and market gardeners know that growing is only half the work they do; the other half is selling their crops. The good news is that the increasing demand for organic food, both here and abroad, offers interesting marketing opportunities to eastern Ontario growers.

The Ottawa region's Canadian Organic Growers invites anyone with an interest in ecologically sound food production and marketing to explore some new ideas at "Growing Organic Crops for Domestic and Export Markets" on Saturday, Jan. 18. The day-long conference, part of Eastern Ontario Farmers' Week, will be held at the W.B. George Centre of Kemptville College. The first speaker of the day is Bob Budd a community-shared agriculture (CSA) guru from Goderich. He and his wife, Bev, are CSA pioneers, running their entire operation on solar energy only.

This year they put up a greenhouse to extend the season, and they are experimenting with the solar drying of a number of the vegetables they grow. Bob will give a presentation at 10:15 a.m., "Developing a CSA program that works for you and your customers," followed by a workshop in the afternoon entitled "CSA: what to grow and how to grow it."

Gerald Poechman, the second speaker, is a cash cropper and large-scale organic egg producer from Walkerton, Ont. With his wife, Marlene, and their

children, he grows organic corn, wheat, spelt, soybeans and spring grains, which he uses in his custom poultry mixes and sells for export.

Gerald is the current president of Ontario Organic Farmers' Cooperative, headquartered in western Ontario. At 11:15 a.m., he will present "The new market challenge: growing organic cash crops (spelt, corn, soybeans, grains)"; his afternoon workshop, "Marketing cash crops: contract growing vs. private sales," will take a practical look at selling.

A third workshop will be offered by Myra Palmer and Donna Broadhead of Curran, Ont. These certified market gardeners, known as The Big Green Women of Planet X, sell produce at the Ottawa organic farmers' market as well as at their farm gate.

The three workshops will all be offered at 1:30 p.m. and again at 2:30 p.m., giving participants the chance to attend any two they choose. Registration is at 9:30 a.m., and the fee is \$15 for the day.

Bring your own lunch or purchase a lunch ticket for \$7.50 at the door. Enjoy browsing through the displays during lunch and coffee breaks.

For more information about this conference, contact Bruce Duncan at (613) 256-2933.

ALMONTE PARKS AND RECREATION

CO-ED FITNESS

Tuesday and Thursday Evenings
6:30 - 7:30 p.m. — ADHS — Gym 1

January 14th - March 6

Cost: \$40⁰⁰ / session
or \$3⁵⁰ / class

Instructor — CATHY DALEY
Registration — 256-1077

For community news
— Read The Gazette

THANK YOU The CAPS Bantam "A Rep." Hockey Team

extends thanks to the following
businesses and individuals
who have made donations.

Canadian Tire, Eades Home Hardware, Larry Smith & Family, Carleton Place Subway, Dave & Garry's All Star Saloon, Visions Bowling, Videoflicks & Carleton Place Loeb.

The recipients were: Hockey Stick — Matt Address; Senators Tickets — Derek Conway, Jamie Black, Ryan Sandberg, Jamie Lee; Sandwich Platter — Jamie Smith; Video Rental — Deller Scott; School Agenda — Anthony Spagnola, Shawn Hopewell; Bowling Games — Carey Smith; T-Shirts — Patrick Wylie, Dillon Solowjew; \$30 Dinner Certificate — Jason Jackson, Craig Hiscoe, John Newton, David Fendley.

Take a Run at A Real Mountain! Guaranteed Downhill Thrills!



Calabogie Peaks

1-800-669-4861

Open Daily 9 a.m. - 4 p.m.

P.S. Show us your season pass from ANY other resort & ski The Peaks 1/2 Price!



Calabogie Peaks Alpine Learning Centre For Boarders and Skiers

WE HAVE IT ALL!

Programs for every age and level —
Beginner to Expert!

Such as NANCY GREENE
and FULL RACING PROGRAM —
WEEKDAYS and WEEKENDS

\$32

Discover Skiing

1 hour lesson
lift ticket
rentals

\$49

Discover Boarding

1-1/2 hour lesson
lift ticket
rentals

\$50

Rossignol

Super Side Cut Clinic

2-1/2 hour lesson
Use of Rossignol 10.4 skis during
lesson

Maximum 3 persons per session

Ski School Director — **Dave Banning**
Nancy Greene Coordinator — **Roger Tuttle**

For more information
1-800-669-4861

Don't keep silent about abuse

By Fern Martin

It's time to make well-meaning resolutions for another year. I want to use this space to give some practical suggestions as to how to deal with those sticky situations where someone says or does something inappropriate and you feel uncomfortable about challenging them and so you don't say anything and then you feel like a schmuck.

My suggestions have to do with the issue of harassment and abuse of women but could also apply to racism, homophobia, etc.

● If you hear someone tell a joke that demeans women, take the person aside, explain that abuse flourishes in a climate that degrades women. Say that their joke doesn't cause abuse but it sets the stage that makes abuse legitimate.

INTERVAL

● If you hear someone use language that is degrading to women or use words that suggest that women are less important than men, take the person aside, explain that language is used to define the status of the individual or object, and that a way to improve the status of women is to use language that is inclusive (applies to both genders) and positive.

● If someone sexually harasses a woman, take the person aside, talk to them about respect, about how the harassment has a detrimental effect on the woman's emotional well-being, as well as her feelings of personal safety. Suggest that an apology is in order. You can also tell the woman that you observed the harassment and that you

will testify on her behalf.

● If you walk into an office or a place of business where pornography is displayed, you can tell the inhabitant of the office that the pornography makes you feel uncomfortable and that you are unable to purchase their product or conduct your business in such a setting.

● If you hear someone verbally abusing his/her partner — take them aside and say that their behaviour is unacceptable, that it makes you feel uncomfortable and concerned for their partner.

● If you witness physical abuse, report it to the police. If you feel safe, you can tell the abuser that such behaviour is unacceptable and criminal and that you feel it is your responsibility to report it.

Of course it's easy to give advice. It's often difficult to

actually carry it out. Keeping silent about abuse allows it to continue and to flourish. Speaking out against abuse is an effective way to raise community standards and to make the world safer for all.

The following quote by 'Abdu'l-Baha may help to inspire us.

"The world of humanity has two wings — one is women and the other men. Not until both wings are equally developed can the bird fly. Should one wing remain weak, flight is impossible."

The Lanark County Interval House crisis and support line numbers are 257-5960 and 1-800-267-7946. Anytime.

The Lanark County Sexual Assault line number for women, teens, men and children is 1-800-387-0844. Anytime.

confidence in conducting do-it-yourself research.

"We are looking forward to working with the seminar participants on Jan. 30 to provide strategies and tactics to help obtain accurate and insightful market research data to assist them in the development of their business ideas."

Further details of the seminar are available from Ernie Banting at the Smiths Falls Business Self-Help Office at (613) 283-4126.

Market research is focus of January seminar

MISSISSAUGA — The Ontario Ministry of Economic Development, Trade and Tourism, the Town of Smiths Falls and the Business Self-Help Office, in partnership with 11 CORINFO Research and Information Services, has announced a date for local delivery of the provincially-recognized entrepreneurship seminar, Street Smart Market Research.

Since the launch of Street Smart Market Research,

thousands of entrepreneurs, inventors and business owners from across Ontario have shared an opportunity to discover insights on how to obtain information to help grow a business or advance the development of a business idea/concept.

Street Smart Market Research will be held on Thursday, Jan. 30 at the Youth Arena Hall in Smiths Falls. The evening seminar begins at 6:30 p.m.

The three-hour Street Smart Research seminar has been designed to:

- (1) address popular misconceptions about market research;
- (2) offer a practical definition of consumer wants vs. needs;
- (3) explore successful market research strategies and tactics;
- (4) help participants with where to find good quality information;
- (5) increase participant

HELP FEED THE HUNGRY IN LANARK COUNTY!!

LANARK COUNTY
FOOD BANK
167B FRANKTOWN
ROAD
CARLETON PLACE,
ONTARIO K7C 2P2



recommended prescription:
Physical Activity

Take it regularly,
to treat aches
and pains,
heart disease
and obesity.

Sharing a
Healthier
Future™
with
PARTICIPATION

Bankruptcy

Your Only Option?

BDO Dunwoody
Limited works closely
with you, on a
confidential basis, to
explore available
alternatives.

Let one of Canada's
largest and longest
established practices
assist you with expert
budget and debt
counselling, creditor
proposals and, if
necessary, bankruptcy.

FIRST CONSULTATION
IS FREE!

820-6685

OUTSIDE OTTAWA CALL TOLL FREE
1-800-754-1579



BDO Dunwoody Limited

Eight locations
in Ottawa and
Eastern Ontario

CB-CP-AG-KC-CG-RM-407